

Impact High · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk The main failure mode is validating the inaccurate claim instead of the understanding

THE MOVE

Name what makes sense -> avoid endorsing the claim -> state your boundary or view separately -> invite the next step. -> Short form: notice -> name or respond -> invite -> calibrate -> release. -> "I can see why that landed that way" — even ?

START HERE

Say "I can see why that landed that way," or "That makes sense as a concern, even if I see the decision differently."

SAY THIS

Quick acknowledgement... *"I can see why."*

Warm validation *"I can see why that felt unfair."*

Work & meetings *"That is a reasonable concern to raise."*

Name it, then state your view... *"I can see why that felt dismissive. I don't think that was the intent."*

De-escalation & repair *"I don't mean I agree with every part; I mean I understand why it felt that way."*

Under pressure *"I'm not going to pretend I agree, but I do understand why you're angry."*

AVOID

- Validation would imply agreement with unsafe behaviour
- You cannot yet identify what is genuinely understandable
- The person needs a clear limit first, not acknowledgement

REMEMBER

Validate the experience; keep the boundary.